

[AI]DGAF

You know what I mean ;-)

Boo-Man | boo@digit.in

Everywhere I go, the only thing that I hear about nowadays is AI. Even here at the Test Centre, everyone is talking about only one thing, generative AI. They went ahead and made AI write the entire magazine. Students are writing their assignments using AI text generators. And, music producers are trying to mimic legends using music generation AI tools.

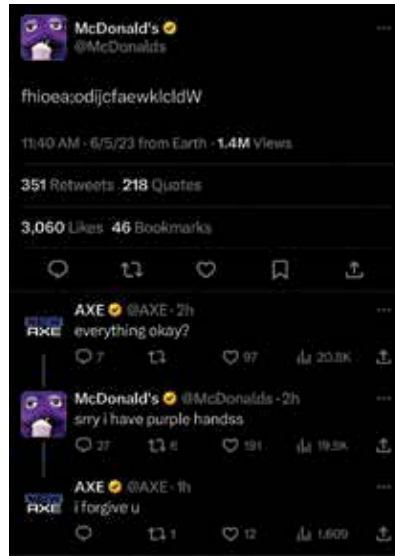
For what joy? And, I for one, do not give a flying f about whatever this is. Before all of you come after me, having euphoric explanations and insights about the title of this write-up, let me make things clear for you.

- A. I don't give a flying f about whatever this new trend is
- AI doesn't give a flying f about whatever you all are hyped up for
- I don't give a f in general. I was born with a handful and many have already been distributed to worthy contenders

Now, if you find some other hidden meaning in all of this, go write a book about it. Send me a copy, winters are close and I have a fireplace which is being built. Coming back to what I was talking about.

When we wrote the AI issue back in April, even I tried my hand at AI tools. And, if you did not notice, the result was a wannabe Boo-Man article. That shows exactly the biggest flaw of AI tools right now. They can't do things on their own.

I don't even know why people are calling it generative AI. It is not. Almost all the famous AI tools right now, work on a single pronged philosophy. They will find content



**Wait... Did I miss something?
Nah, everything is fine. People are still talking. This wasn't AI**

on the internet that aligns with your query. After that, the tool will work it's "magic", I don't know what is so wonderful about it, but meh, and you'll be presented with a piece of content that seems original, but is not.

AI is like that one dumpster diver that will be lurking around stores and put together an iPhone and try to sell it on eBay, trying to pass it off as a used device. I know most of you YouTube people who are addicted to that sort of content would have gotten that reference. As for the ones who didn't have a clue what I wrote, leave it. Your soul is too pure for this world. Stay in the shell that you are in.

In all the content that is generated by AI, I don't see the innate human creativity anywhere. It is all just falsely romanticised ideas that are put together. And, the folks on the internet, celebrate! My only question to them is, for what joy?

I don't quote a lot of people, but one line that I came across recently, was by Ben Franklin, and in case of the so-called generative AI, it stands true - "Originality is the art of concealing your sources."

Ben, you nailed it man!

Calling AI "generative" is not only misleading, but it also undermines the incredible human capacity for creativity. It diminishes the countless hours of practice, the deep emotional connections, and the sheer brilliance that artists, writers, and musicians possess.

Now, if you have some semblance of the content that is being put out on the internet, you would have instantly identified that the paragraph above, was written by an AI.

Just in case you were not able to identify, then person, I am sorry for you. AI still has a long way to go.

If you made it so far into the article, then you would have understood that I am more sad than angry right now. As Mithun had pointed out in this column a couple of months ago, some time in the future, we will have a time where AI models are running around on the internet, talking amongst themselves, having what we call as 'hallucin(ai)tions' and we will be sitting there in awe of the mess that we have created.

Understand what AI is capable of. Celebrating its success irrationally right now, will lead to nothing but disappointment later, when you are left without a job and stacks of bills that were generated by the many generative AI services you had signed up for.

I'm so sick and tired of all this now, that I had to call up Gangsta Granny and Agent 001 to speak about everything that is going on. And, you know what they said: "We don't give a flying f about whatever this new age AI thing is." 